

ENTREPRENEURIAL PULSE



E-club APIIT

apiit_eclub



UNLEASH YOUR BEST U

**ON**

the 1st of August 2024, the Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT, in collaboration with Unilever and the Unilever Sparks program, hosted a highly insightful session titled Unleash Your Best U.

This event aimed to equip young undergraduates with key knowledge on corporate etiquette and personal branding—essential elements for thriving in today's competitive professional landscape. The session was led by Mr. Shamil Akbar, Internal Communications Manager and Executive Assistant to the CEO of Unilever Sri Lanka, and saw a strong turnout of enthusiastic students. The event, chaired by E-Club Head of Marketing and Unilever Spark, Sheraya Samaranayake, was a resounding success.



Held at City Campus L5 CR4 from 8:45 to 10:30 AM, it attracted a large audience eager to learn how to craft their professional identities and align their personal values with their career aspirations. In his talk, Mr. Akbar highlighted how personal branding is more than just a buzzword; it is a strategic tool that can significantly influence career growth. In today's corporate world, having a unique and authentic brand can set individuals apart from the competition, open doors to new opportunities, and establish a professional presence that resonates with employers and industry leaders alike.

Unleash Your Best U!



By focusing on these areas, young graduates can shape their personal and professional journeys to reflect both who they are and who they aspire to become. Unleash Your Best U provided a platform for students to rethink their approach to career growth and self-presentation. The lessons imparted by Mr. Akbar will undoubtedly resonate with attendees as they step into the world of work, equipped with the skills and mindset necessary to succeed in today's dynamic business environment.



The session stressed that financial literacy goes hand in hand with personal development. Proper financial planning isn't just about saving or investing—it's about setting financial goals, creating budgets, managing debt, and making informed decisions that align with one's lifestyle and aspirations. The CAL experts discussed how good financial habits can lead to greater financial freedom, reduced stress, and the ability to pursue personal and professional ambitions without the burden of financial uncertainty. Moreover, the importance of setting clear financial goals and having a structured plan was emphasized as key to achieving financial success.



FinLit with CAL provided attendees with not just the knowledge but the motivation to start thinking seriously about their financial futures. By understanding the principles of smart investing and effective financial planning, young undergraduates can take their first steps toward securing financial independence and stability. This session was more than just a discussion on finance; it was an important reminder of how financial literacy and strategic planning are integral to personal growth.



FINLIT WITH CAL

FinLit by CAL

Your Partner in Financial Freedom

Topics Covered

- Starting your Investing Journey.
- Non-bank Investment Options.
- Diversifying your Investment Portfolio.
- Macroeconomic Outlook.

ON the 8th of August 2024, the Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT, in collaboration with CAL, a leading investment bank in Sri Lanka, organized FinLit with CAL, a session focused on the essentials of financial literacy and investing for young undergraduates. This event aimed to help students understand the importance of making informed financial decisions with members of the CAL team led the session, offering a comprehensive look into the world of investing, with an emphasis on how young professionals can plan their finances effectively. The event was chaired by E-Club President Vidussh Gunasekera and drew a large and engaged audience. It was held at City Campus L3 CR5 from 11:00 AM to 12:00 PM.



UPCOMING EVENTS

Towers 2 while the grand finale will take place at the Commercial Credit Academic Center in Bolgoda with grand honours. With more than 20 teams from various schools in the Colombo and Gampaha districts participating, Sandbox is surely a competition not to miss. Registrations close on the 30th of August 2024. Participating teams include DS Senanayake, Ananda, Nalanda, Thurstan, Gateway, the British School, Museaus, St Peters, St Bridgets, Holy Cross Gampaha and Bandaranayake Central College.

TUESDAY
**10
SEP**



APIIT CITY CAMPUS
NO. 388 UNION PL, COLOMBO 02

WEDNESDAY
**18
SEP**



ACCESS TOWERS 2
NO. 278 UNION PL, COLOMBO 02

TUESDAY
**24
SEP**



COMMERCIAL CREDIT ACADEMIC
CENTER
BOLGODA

SANDBOX SO FAR

APIIT
Inspire love for learning



ENTREPRENEURSHIP CLUB
OF APIIT

Feel like you got the
perfect **business idea?**

REGISTRATIONS ARE NOW **OPEN**

The Sandbox saga continues as the Entrepreneurship Club embarks on it's biggest adventure yet. This exciting new project is the signature project of the club for the 2023/2024 tenure and is one not to miss. The final dates for the competition have finally been set, taking place over three days in the month of September 2024 - 10th September being a value adding learning session, 18th September being the preliminary rounds and 24th September being the grand finale. The first two rounds will take place at APIIT City campus auditorium and Access

SHARE THE STORY

APIIT
Inspire love for learning



ENTREPRENEURSHIP CLUB
OF APIIT

Share the Story!
CALL FOR VOLUNTEERS

Share the Story is one of the most unique projects undertaken by the Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT Colombo in collaboration with the Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT Kandy Campus. Being a community project, this project saw the two clubs embarking on a drive to collect a variety of books for donation from story books to atlases to non-fiction fact books with nearly a collection of 100 books by the donation deadline of August 23rd. The donation point was the City Campus Library for Colombo.

The 2nd Phase of the project will see the Entrepreneurship Club of Colombo going to Kandy on the 04th of September and participating in the donation of books and stationery packs to the school students of Dambawela Primary School. The club is **calling for 05 volunteers** to participate in this exciting project and join the club EXCO in the journey to Kandy. Registrations open now on a first come first serve basis.



STUDENT ENTREPRENEUR SPOTLIGHT:

FATHIMA SALIHA

BUSINESS PROFILE:

Littlemissbakery is your go-to destination for delightful homemade cakes, brownies, and cookies. With a deep passion for baking and an unwavering commitment to quality, we craft sweet treats that bring joy to every occasion. At LittleMissBakery, we're here to make your days a little sweeter!

Little Miss Bakery.
cookies, cakes and other takes
| EST. 2023 |

1. What sparked your entrepreneurial spirit? How did you come up with your business idea?

I always had an interest in baking since it was therapeutic for me. However, my early attempts often ended in epic failures, and even now, I still face occasional mishaps. To improve, I took a course and got better at it. This improvement and my passion for baking eventually sparked the idea of turning it into a business.

2. What have been the biggest challenges you've faced so far? What have you learned the most from these experiences?

The biggest challenges have been managing time between baking and other commitments, dealing with the occasional baking failures, and learning how to market my products effectively. From these experiences, I've learned the importance of persistence, continuous learning, and adapting to feedback.

3. Why do you prefer running your own venture?

Because I'm my own boss, I enjoy the autonomy and the ability to make my own decisions. It gives me a sense of control and fulfillment that I wouldn't get working for someone else.



4. What resources have been most helpful to you as a student entrepreneur?

Courses on baking, online marketing resources, and networking with other entrepreneurs have been incredibly helpful. My cousin, who also owns a business, has been a valuable resource as we share our experiences and learn from each other.

5. How do you balance your studies with running your business? Do you have any time management tips for other student entrepreneurs?

Balancing studies and running a business requires strict time management and prioritization. I make use of planners and to-do lists to keep track of tasks and deadlines. My tip for other student entrepreneurs is to set clear boundaries between study time and business time, and to not hesitate to ask for help when needed.

6. How are you marketing your business and reaching your target audience? What strategies have been most effective?

I use social media platforms to showcase my baked goods and engage with my audience. Word of mouth has also been very effective. Hosting small events and offering samples has helped attract more customers.

7. What impact do you hope your business will have? Where do you see your business in 5- 10 years?

I hope my business can bring joy to people through delicious baked goods and inspire others to pursue their passions. In 5-10 years, I see my business expanding with a physical storefront and a larger customer base.

8. Do you have any mentors or advisors who have supported your journey?

Yes, my cousin, who also owns a business, has been a great mentor. We share our experiences and help each other improve.

 @littlemissbakery.lk

9. What advice would you give to other students seeking mentorship?

Seek out mentors who have experience in your field and are willing to share their knowledge. Don't be afraid to reach out and ask for guidance, as most people are pleased to help if they can.



10. What are your top three pieces of advice for aspiring student entrepreneurs? What keeps you motivated and inspired?

- 1 - Stay persistent: There will be challenges, but don't give up.
 - 2 - Keep learning: Take courses, read books, and seek feedback to improve continuously.
 - 3 - Network: Connect with other entrepreneurs and learn from their experiences.
- My passion for baking and the positive feedback from customers keep me motivated and inspired.

11. Looking back, would you do anything differently? What have you enjoyed most about your entrepreneurial journey as a student?

I don't think I would have done anything differently, except perhaps taking a few more piping courses for my cakes. The journey itself has been enjoyable because baking is my therapy and seeing people enjoy my creations brings me immense joy.

THE FUTURE OF BUSINESS AND ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE: A NEW PHASE OF EFFICIENCY AND CREATIVITY

WRITTEN BY JANANI CHAYA WALISINGHA



The CEO of Amazon Jeff Bezos has once said " Artificial Intelligence will be part of every industry, enhancing abilities in ways we can't even imagine yet". As we advance further into the 21st century the integration of artificial intelligence (AI) into business operations is transforming industries and reshaping the global economic landscape. The convergence of business and Artificial Intelligence promises a future characterized by unprecedented levels of innovation, efficiency and strategic advance.

The capacity of Artificial Intelligence to swiftly process and evaluate enormous volumes of data in transforming commercial decision-making. Businesses are able to make more precise and well-informed decisions because to the insights that machine learning algorithms and predictive analytics offer that were before impossible. Artificial Intelligence enables firms to predict changes and adapt to them more quickly, from improving supply networks to projecting market trends.

Artificial Intelligence driven by automation is revolutionizing operational efficiency by automating routine tasks, reducing costs and human error, allowing employees to focus on strategic planning and creative problem-solving. The automation of routine tasks, from data entry to complex administrative functions, has significantly improved.



The rapid advancement of Artificial Intelligence technology is expected to present numerous challenges to both companies and their employees. Artificial Intelligence decrease task requirements and shift job roles by boosting demand for skilled workers who can effectively utilize Artificial Intelligence. At the same time, Artificial Intelligence has the potential to decrease the number of individuals required to perform specific tasks simultaneously.

Artificial Intelligence offers new opportunities, but businesses must adapt by funding professional development and attending industry events to stay updated with Artificial Intelligence developments. Artificial Intelligence can drive towards prosperity and sustainability by recognizing opportunities and strategically integrating it into business practices, shaping the future of business. Organizations can harness the potential of Artificial Intelligence to promote prosperity and sustainability by adopting this technology.



Gen AI is primarily utilized by organizations in marketing sales, product development, risk, legal, compliance, strategy, co-operate finance, and supply chain and inventory management.

Artificial Intelligence can leverage their limitless potential by hiring upskilled employees with Artificial Intelligence expertise to lead AI initiatives within the organization. The organizations can create an Artificial Intelligence strategy that is in line with your business's objectives and goals. Artificial Intelligence can be used to pinpoint sustainable practices such as energy efficiency and waste production.

Ultimately, Artificial Intelligence is a promising solution to the hybrid world crisis, as it will enhance business efficiencies and customer experience in the long run. It is better to for every industry to get prepared for an era of Artificial Intelligence.

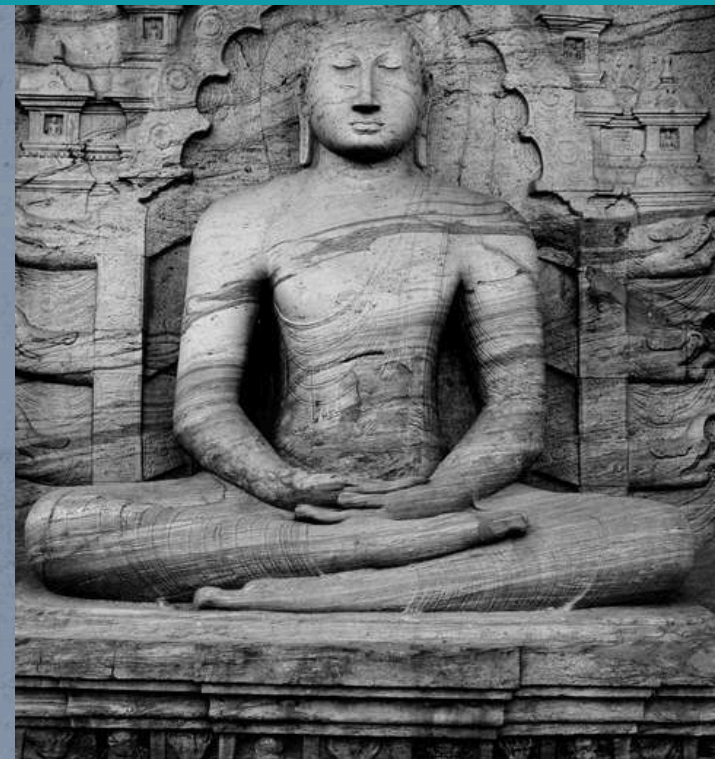
ANNOUNCEMENTS

photopreneur: grand exhibition

photopreneur is a photography competition that empowers entrepreneurs through the art of photography.

date -
06th September 2024, 11AM onwards

venue -
canteen, city campus



BUSINESS UPDATES



DISNEY PLANS A NEW ROUND OF JOB CUTS IN ITS TELEVISION OPERATION



BLUE DIAMONDS JEWELLERY TO TRANSITION TO JIT BUSINESS MODEL



BILL AKAMAN'S IPO DREAM IMPLODES FROM \$25 BILLION TO ZERO IN WEEKS



APPLE REVENUE TOPS ESTIMATES EVEN AS CHINA SALES REMAIN LOW

ATTENTION WRITERS!



READY TO SPARK INNOVATION?

BEGIN WRITING NOW AND JOIN OUR INAUGURAL NEWSLETTER. LET'S FUEL THE RISE OF TOMORROW'S ENTREPRENEURS!

SUBMIT YOUR WORK TO ECLUB@APIIT.LK

OPEN TO BOTH STUDENTS AND LECTURERS!

